

April

16

1346

Dušan the Mighty

The powerful Serbian king Stephen Dušan crowned himself emperor of Serbia, Greece, and Bulgaria. During his reign, the Serbian Empire expanded to include most of southeast Europe.



Born this day

1755 **Élisabeth Vigée-Le Brun**, French painter. One of the most successful female artists of her time, she painted portraits of various famous women, including Queen Marie Antoinette.

2020

Birthday walk

Just before his 100th birthday, former British Army officer Captain Tom Moore walked 100 sponsored laps of his garden, raising more than £30 million to support medical charities during the COVID-19 pandemic.



Also on this day

1746 The French-supported Jacobite army was defeated at the Battle of Culloden, ending their fight to seize the British throne.

1847 In New Zealand, a British officer shot a Māori chief by accident, causing conflict between Indigenous Māori and British settlers.

1853 A 21-gun salute was fired to celebrate India's first passenger train, which travelled from Mumbai (then called Bombay) to Thane, a distance of 34 km (21 miles).

Panda presents

1972

US president Richard Nixon and First Lady Pat Nixon welcomed two young giant pandas, Ling-Ling and Hsing-Hsing, to the Smithsonian's National Zoo at Washington, DC, USA. The popular pair had been sent as gifts by Chinese premier Zhou Enlai.

